



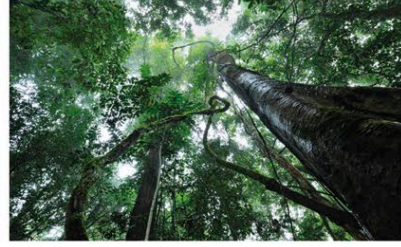
Agriculture

In 1700 CE, about 7 percent of Earth's land area was used for growing crops and raising farm animals. Today, that figure has risen to about 50 percent.



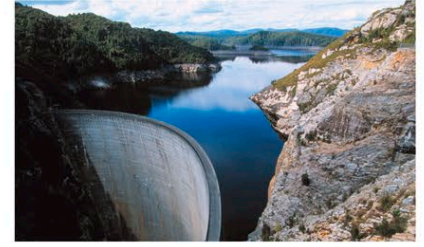
Pollution

Vehicle exhaust gases, smoke and waste chemicals from factories, and oil spills all poison the environment, threatening plant and animal life.



Conservation

To protect the plant and animal life of unique habitats, many countries set up conservation areas, where no farming, industry, or new settlement can occur.



Using water

We build dams and reservoirs to store water. We need it for drinking, for use in industrial processes, and to irrigate crops and generate electricity.



Successful species

Part of the success of humans is due to our ability to use the materials around us to give us protection and shelter. This ability opens up nearly every part of the globe for human living space, no matter how harsh the environment. Even thousands of years ago, the Inuit of the North American Arctic made coats from the fur of caribou (reindeer) and waterproof boots from seal skin. They found a way to live on the meager resources of the high Arctic.

Inuit boat

The *umiak* is a type of traditional open boat used by Inuit people. The frame is made of driftwood or whalebone, with a walrus- or seal-skin covering. These boats are still used, since the law allows whale hunting only with traditional Inuit tools.